

by age 30. I don't touch my retirement savings, so it simply grows with the market. In addition to my 401(k), my husband and I have an investment portfolio that is just as successful. Contrary to the retirement portfolio, we occasionally do sell shares and use the earnings to cover additional “fun” expenses and purchases. Ultimately, the goal for this portfolio is for it to pay for the “nice to haves” in our lives, possibly fund real estate investments, and make working optional. It's important to note that the success of any portfolio depends on the market, so it can all vary. Nonetheless, with consistent contributions and the right strategy, it's destined to grow.

Q. What is your current investing approach?

A. I invest 15% of my income into my 401(k), my husband and I invest a portion of our after-tax income into the stock market for non-retirement expenditures, and we plan to begin investing in real estate after paying off our primary residence. To provide additional details, my current strategy, outside of my 401(k), is value investing. Some would call it the Warren Buffett way of investing. Having an employer-provided 401(k) obviously limits your options for investing, so my 401(k) investing strategy is pretty set based on my retirement age target date. However, for investments outside of retirement, we set aside a portion of our income each year to put into the stock market. We typically buy more of the stocks that we already have and, on occasion, introduce some new companies into our portfolio. We utilize an online broker to make all of our investment transactions.

Q. How would you describe your risk tolerance?

A. I'd say that I'm risk-averse. My husband and I manage our portfolio together and our strategy is to buy and hold. We don't trade and tend to go for companies within industries that we know and that have longevity.

Q. What tips would you give to women reading this wanting to get started with investing?

A. My advice would be to first create a plan to manage the funds that you currently have. Get on a budget, get out of debt, save, and then create a plan to start investing. Do your research on which style of investing is best suited to your financial goals. Set aside a small amount of money to get